

EMOTIV BCI Drone

Fly a drone with your mind. Everything you need to install the app and run your first session.

Before you start

Three things need to be in place. The installer cannot provide any of them, so it is worth checking first.

WHAT	WHY
A Windows PC	Windows 10 or 11, 64-bit. Nothing else needs installing — no Python, no developer tools.
EMOTIV Launcher	Installed, running, and signed in to your EMOTIV account. The app talks to your headset through Launcher, so it must be open the whole time.
An EMOTIV headset	Insight, Insight 2, EPOC X, EPOC+ or MN8. Pair it in EMOTIV Launcher first, and make sure it appears there before opening the drone app.

You will also need a Client ID and Client Secret. These come from whoever sent you the app, or from your own EMOTIV account. The app asks for them once, the first time you open it, and never again.

Installing

One file, about 84 MB. It installs for your user account only, so it will not ask for an administrator password.

1 Run the installer

Double-click `EMOTIV-Drone-BCI-windows-x64-setup.exe`.

2 Get past the blue warning screen

Windows shows “Windows protected your PC”. This appears because the app has no commercial signing certificate, not because anything is wrong with it. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.

3 Follow the installer

Accept the default location. Tick the desktop shortcut if you want one. It finishes in a few seconds and offers to launch the app.

First time you open it

A one-time setup, asked once per computer. After this the app goes straight to the headset list every time.

1 Enter your credentials

Paste the **Client ID** and **Client Secret** into the two boxes and press **Connect**.

2 Approve the app in EMOTIV Launcher

Launcher shows a permission request. Accept it there. The drone app displays “Waiting for EMOTIV Launcher...” and continues on its own once you have approved — you do not need to press anything else.

That is the setup finished. Your credentials are saved on this computer. The next time you open the app it connects on its own and goes straight to choosing a headset.

Running a session

Three numbered steps inside the app, then the game.

1 Select your headset

Every headset in range is listed with a picture and its status. Press **Connect Headset** on the one you are wearing.

2 Enter the player's name

This name is what appears on the leaderboard, so type the name of the person who is about to play.

3 Check the sensors

A head diagram shows each sensor where it actually sits. Green is good contact, red needs adjusting — wet the felts or reseal the headset until the reading is above 50%. **Start Training** becomes available once contact is good enough.

4 Train two thoughts

First **Neutral**: relax and keep your mind clear for eight seconds. Then **Push**: imagine pushing the drone forward. Accept a take if it felt right, or retry it. Training takes about a minute.

5 Fly

Press **Start Run**. After a 3–2–1 countdown you have 60 seconds to fly through as many rings as you can. Each ring is 10 points, and your score goes on the leaderboard.

The two controls

Turn your head	Steers the drone left and right.
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Think “Push”	Flies the drone forward. This is the thought you trained.
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Recenter Headset	Sets your current head position as the new straight-ahead. Press it whenever the drone drifts while you are sitting still.
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Handing over to the next person

Built for passing one headset around a room.

When a run ends, press **Finish — next player**. The app deletes the trained profile, disconnects the headset and rescans, and clears the name box ready for whoever is next. The score stays on the leaderboard under the name that earned it.

To keep the same person and only redo their training, use **Reset & Retrain** on the flight screen instead.

If something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
“EMOTIV Cortex did not respond”	EMOTIV Launcher is not running, or is not signed in. Open it, sign in, then press Connect again.
“Waiting for EMOTIV Launcher...” and nothing happens	Switch to EMOTIV Launcher and look for the permission request. It sometimes opens behind other windows.
“Invalid Client Credentials”	The Client ID or Secret is wrong. Retype them carefully — a trailing space when pasting is the usual cause.
No headsets in the list	Check the headset is on and paired in EMOTIV Launcher, then press Refresh .
Start Training stays greyed out	Sensor contact is below 50%. Wet the felt pads, press the headset gently against the head, and watch the red dots on the diagram turn green.
Headset disconnected mid-run	The app tries to reconnect for 30 seconds by itself. Put the headset back on and it picks up where it left off.

Reporting a problem? Send the log file. It records everything the app did, and it is far more useful than a description of what happened:

```
%APPDATA%\EmotivDrone\emotiv-drone.log
```

Paste that path into the Windows Explorer address bar to find it. The app also shows the location on the connection screen.

Where your settings live

All in one folder. These survive uninstalling, so scores and credentials are not lost by reinstalling.

FILE	HOLDS
<code>credentials.json</code>	Your Client ID and Secret. Delete this file to be asked for them again.

FILE	HOLDS
<code>config.json</code>	Language, sensitivity and headset settings.
<code>leaderboard.json</code>	Every score recorded on this computer.
<code>emotiv-drone.log</code>	Diagnostic log. Send this when reporting a problem.

The folder is `%APPDATA%\EmotivDrone` — paste that into Explorer’s address bar.

Switch between **English** and **中文** at any time using the dropdown in the app’s top-right corner. The change is immediate and is remembered next time.

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